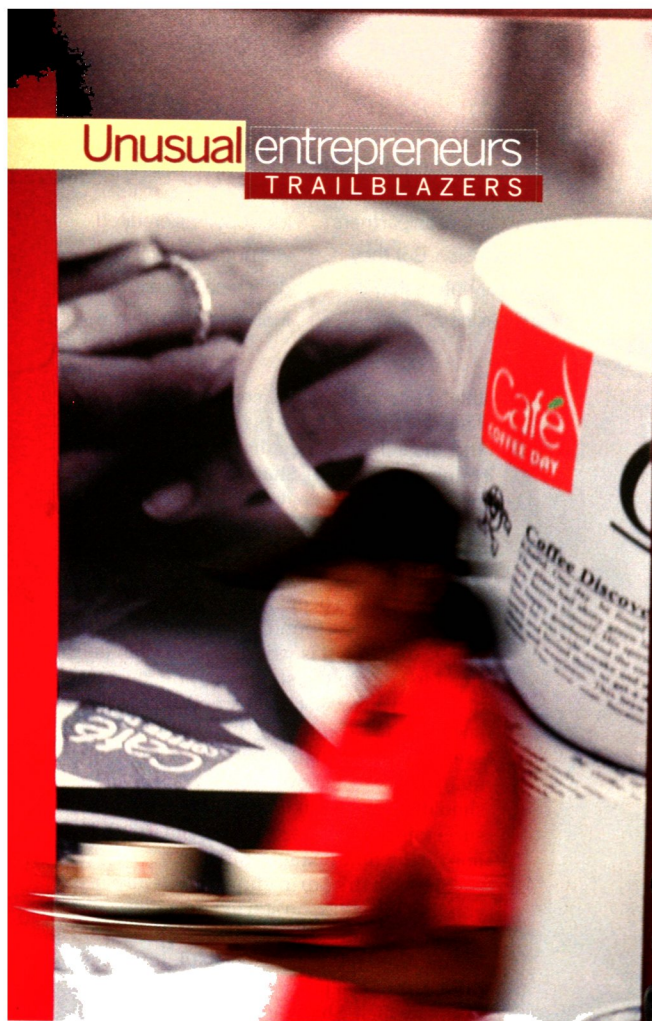




Unusual entrepreneurs TRAILBLAZERS

V.G.
SIDDHARTHA

49, COFFEE RETAILER

CHAIRMAN, AMALGAMATED BEAN COFFEE TRADING COMPANY

TURNOVER IN 1993 Rs 10 crore

CURRENT TURNOVER Rs 700 crore

BREW-EYED BOY

India will be drinking a lot more coffee over the next few years, if V.G. Siddhartha, chairman of Amalgamated Bean Coffee Trading Company Ltd (ABCTCL), is to be believed. His confidence doesn't merely stem from the fact that he runs Coffee Day, the country's largest coffee chain. His number crunching shows that as a country's economy grows, consumption of coffee increases. And India's per capita consumption of coffee at 90 gm has the potential to go up to 1 kg in a few years. As the country marches towards

economic prosperity, his company is well placed to cater to the coffee connoisseur through multiple touch-points. From vending machines in corporate offices, express vends in public places to Coffee Day outlets spread across the country, he serves a million customers daily. With 700 coffee cafes in India, spread across 105 cities, Café Coffee Day (CCD) arrived as a national coffee retail brand in 2003.

None of this, however, was ever clearly planned strategy. Even though his family owned some coffee plantations in Chik-